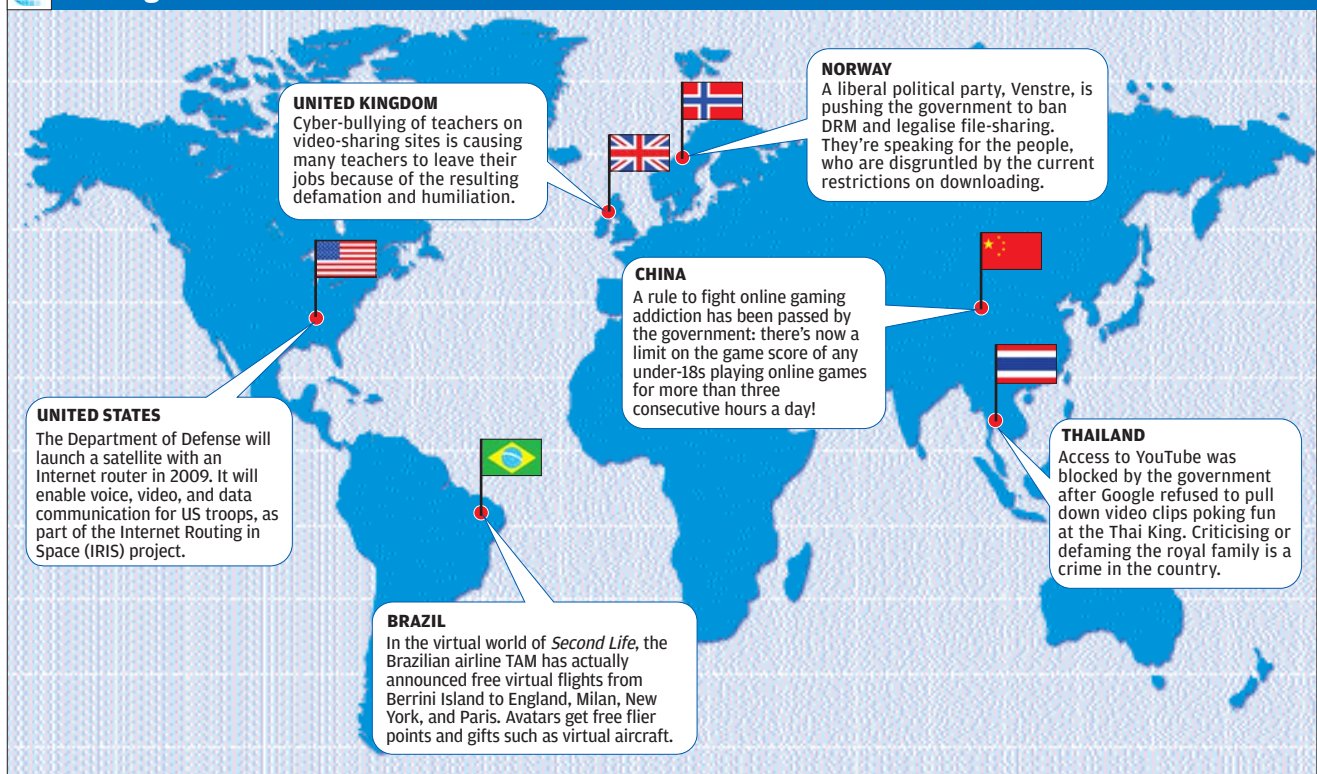




CRAPWARE AND XP

XP Makes A Comeback, Crapware Kills The Joy

Yes, that is a word. Crapware stands for anything that's bundled with your PC that you don't want. When you buy a branded PC, it comes preloaded with an OS and a really big bundle of junk software. This includes anti-virus and security software, multimedia tools, system tools and a whole load of Internet related rubbish. Sure a lot of the software is good, but all we get are the trial versions. Why buy the full versions when there are so many free alternatives floating around?

Consider this: you get a brand new PC, the glint from it is hurting your eyes. It's a dual-core CPU with 2 GB of RAM and a rather large hard drive, but switch it on and it starts up laboriously. Anyone who's

ever formatted and reinstalled Windows will testify to the speediness with which it starts up before you install all your software. Branded PC buyers, however, get tonnes of software pre-installed. They don't ask for it, they don't want it, but it's provided anyway. Why? Simple: PC manufacturers try and cut costs everywhere they can. One way is to bundle trial versions of popular paid software, pick up some money from these "advertisers" and bring prices down to a point where PC brands and assemblers are fighting over a small price difference.

Sadly, since everyone uses OEM bundling of Windows, it's not like you can get your own Windows CD and format to get rid of this crapware. God forbid you have an OS crash and have to load from the backup drive—you get those trial applications installed again, and have to spend time cleaning up the mess.

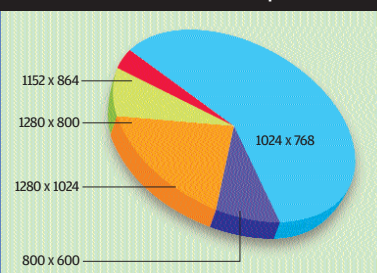
Here in India, the solution seems to be: keep your bill safely, format, install a pirated version and



Stat Attack

It's all in the numbers

The world's favourite desktop resolution



Europeans on average get their first phone at 8. They'll spend **\$28K (Rs 13 lakh)** on handsets and services during their lifetimes.

The typical office worker is **interrupted every 3 minutes** by a phone call, e-mail, IM, or other distraction. But it takes **8 uninterrupted minutes** for a brain to get into **creative** mode.

Staying Connected:

81% use a mobile phone. **65%** use a laptop. **19%** use a smartphone.

31,842 PS3s donated
417 Teraflops to
folding@home;
1,85,618 PCs do 117—
making each PS3
worth about 22 PCs!

Firefox is most used
in Oceania and
Europe (24% in
both). In North
America: 15%. And in
Asia: 12%.